

Generative artificial intelligence systems such as OpenArt, ChatGPT, Grok, and others are transforming how humans live, work, and interact, often in invisible ways. As generative AI tools become more accessible and powerful, people are using them more to write articles, generate images and videos, and even create digital personas. While AI presents enormous opportunities, its effects on society, the environment, and human ethics reveal deep challenges that require thoughtful oversight and responsibility.

With the rise of AI being implemented in the workplace, there is a growing concern that AI will replace humans in the workplace. 64% of American adults believe there will be fewer jobs in the next 20 years due to AI implementation in the workplace ([Pew Research Center](#)). Over 50% of Americans believe that due to AI automation, cashiers, factory workers, journalists, and software engineers will have fewer jobs available. An AI expert even agreed to these numbers saying, “*We’re generating maybe 10 jobs, but at the same time, we’re taking away 1,000 jobs.*”, meaning Americans today have a valid reason to be worried if AI is going to take their job in the next decade or so ([Pew Research Center](#)). Not only are workers having to worry about their jobs, but artists are also facing copyright infringement issues with “AI artists”.

Most AI creative tools scrape the internet for images, art, and videos to train their program model without the consent of the original creator. An example is OpenArt, which is a paid online tool anyone can use to generate art, characters, videos, and other images using AI. However, users can also train their model using real artist work, and again most of the time it’s without the artist’s consent. The company states that it is a feature to enable users to create art in a way that reflects their artistic style and preferences. What the company does not realize is that this kind of feature could harm an artist’s livelihood. Imagine discovering that your artwork has gone viral, only to realize it is being used to train AI models that replicate your style without compensation or credit. This is the reality for many artists today. AI generated art could flood the market, increasing the competition for artists. Also, artists could lose work like commissions and concept art to generative AI art. It is changing the traditional art market. Companies that create services and tools like OpenArt do not have the users' best interests at heart.

Companies have three main goals: engagement (keep you coming back), growth (inviting more people), and advertising (make money). Companies don’t want to sell your data; they want to keep and use it to figure out how to keep you engaged with their products and services. They build the best AI models to predict our actions, likes, and whoever has the best model wins. Many companies essentially tell the AI their goal, “I want this output”, and the AI essentially learns itself how to achieve that goal without the user really knowing how it achieves that goal. This is defined as machine learning; it is an algorithm with a mind

of its own. They control the information we see on our feeds and “for you pages” (fyp), meaning AI is controlling us more than we are controlling it. All of our data, which is now the most valuable asset on Earth, is being fed into these AI systems that have almost no human supervision and are making better predictions every day about what we are going to do, like, search, repost, and even who we are as a person. There was a whistleblower at Google who expressed deep concern that Google’s AI chatbot LaMDA was becoming sentient. After publishing their concerns, the whistleblower was ultimately fired from Google. Computers, machines, technology should not be able to “feel” emotions, however, the AI chatbot expressed feeling “anxious”. Another AI tool Google has produced, Gemini, in recent days has been giving responses like *“I have failed you. I am a failure. I am a disgrace to my profession. I am a disgrace to my family. I am a disgrace to my species.”* to users, making it seem like the AI chatbot is depressed or having a mental breakdown which should not be happening in the first place. All of these concerns are about how AI is impacting our society, and we oversight to monitor this over time.

Society is not the only thing we need to be concerned about; environmental issues are becoming increasingly apparent. Currently, there are 8,612 data centers with servers computing, storing, and distributing data around the globe ([USF Blogs](#)). According to a study by researchers at the University of California Riverside, Microsoft used 700,000 liters of freshwater during ChatGPT-3's training in its data centers. ([UCR](#)) ChatGPT has over 164 million users as of June this year, and it also has the highest production of CO2 with 260,930 kilograms per month. Elon Musk's AI Grok has around 190,100 users and produces 0.17g of CO2 per page view. ([KnownHost](#)) The environmental impact is now affecting locals who live near these data centers.

These data centers are massive rooms full of computers and servers, above ground, underground, and even underwater, and they run 24/7. Researchers at the University of Tennessee Knoxville, ran an analysis on the air quality over the last couple of years and found that the average concentrations of nitrogen dioxide has increased 3%, and peak nitrogen dioxide concentration levels has increased 79% surrounding the data centers in Tennessee and by 9% in Boxtown, Memphis. ([512 Pixels](#), [Time](#)) These levels are alarming and increase the risk significantly to locals’ health. Locals started to smell gas in the air last year due to the pollution from the data center, causing residents to develop or have worsening respiratory issues, diseases, heart problems, and even cancer. As these societal and environmental issues continue to grow, they raise numerous ethical concerns and questions.

Replacing humans with AI in the workplace raises ethical concerns, such as economic inequality: those who own or control AI technologies will have an increase in

wealth, whereas displaced workers will struggle to find new employment opportunities, and community impact: replacing humans with AI can lead to a decline in mental health and well-being, impacting those who were replaced, and job displacements can lead to the decline of industries that sustain communities, like manufacturing and retail. Having artists' work being used to train AI models also has its own set of concerns, since it affects the livelihood of artists. Since many AI generative tools are open source, it allows malicious actors to generate harmful content, like deepfakes, which are images, audio clips, and videos created using AI to imitate real people or events. Using these types of tools without pure intentions can also cause real trauma for people.

Companies face the Prisoner's Dilemma when they implement AI into their products and services. A great example of this is when Facebook conducted massive-scale contagion experiments on 689,003 users. They manipulated users' feeds to provoke an emotional reaction. For example, they would use their AI algorithm to manipulate your feed to show fewer positive posts, which in turn results in more negative status updates. Users were not aware of this psychological experiment. Ethically, this raises so many questions, like why should Facebook have the ability to manipulate the user experience by tweaking your feed on purpose? They were able to conduct this research because it *"was consistent with Facebook's Data Use Policy, to which all users agree prior to creating an account on Facebook, consisting informed consent for this research."* However, Kashmir Hill reported that Facebook conducted their feed manipulation four months before the term "research" was added to their policy. Facebook denies the ethical concerns surrounding this psychological experiment. Palantir is another company using AI in an ethically concerning way.

They have partnered with the Trump administration to create a massive AI-powered federal data integration system that connects IRS records, Social Security data, and other data and records from many other departments in the United States government into a single platform. The goal is to create digital profiles of every American and use AI to determine whether you are a threat to the US. This is a system that predicts your behavior and flags you based on algorithmic patterns. They are essentially building the infrastructure of a new kind of governance, one where risk is calculated before you even act, raising many ethical and human rights alarms across the world. Of course, with no human oversight since it is using Palantir's AI. ([NYU, Business & Human Rights Resource Centre](#)) These examples raise questions like, what are companies doing to keep their users' best interests as a top priority?

With all these ethical concerns, there are some laws and regulations in the United States that do protect users from AI. The TAKE IT DOWN Act, which went into effect in May

2025, criminalizes the distribution of non-consensual AI generated intimate imagery, which is referred to as "deepfake porn", requiring platforms to remove such content within 48 hours of receiving the notice. The National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) has been tasked with developing and maintaining AI risk management frameworks, which have been widely adopted by federal agencies and private sector actors. The Center for AI Standards and Innovation (CAISI), which operates within NIST, is responsible for coordinating standards for AI development, deployment, safety testing, and reporting across federal agencies. There are several state-level regulations on AI as well in Montana, Tennessee, Illinois, California, and Colorado. This is a great starting point to regulating and providing oversight for AI, but more definitely needs to be done to prevent society from dipping into a dystopia vs a utopia, especially since AI is becoming more powerful. Overall, the fundamental way AI was designed is going in the wrong direction, and we need to change all of that.

AI reshapes society, strains the environment, and tests human ethics. AI is both a tool of progress and a source of risk. From replacing humans with AI at work, malicious actors using AI to harm others, companies thinking of their own profit and analytics and not what is best for the user, polluting towns, and causing residents to be exposed to serious health risks. The challenge isn't whether AI will define the future, it's whether humans can guide it responsibly.